

GEOPOLITICS

The Scramble for the Deep Sea

As land-based resources dwindle, superpowers are turning their gaze to the ocean floor. A new cold war is brewing in international waters.



The Untapped Frontier

Miles beneath the ocean surface lie polymetallic nodules—potato-sized rocks rich in cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements.

These minerals are the lifeblood of the green energy transition. Until recently, they were unreachable.



Staggering Wealth

\$15T

ESTIMATED VALUE

The Clarion-Clipperton Zone

Located in the Pacific, this massive abyssal plain alone is estimated to contain more nickel, manganese, and cobalt than all terrestrial reserves combined.



The Chessboard

CHINA'S MONOPOLY

Beijing currently controls over 70% of the world's rare earth processing. It holds the most ISA exploration contracts.

WESTERN ANXIETIES

The US, not having ratified the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, is sidelined at the ISA.



A Legal Void



- The high seas belong to no single nation, governed loosely as the "common heritage of mankind."
- Environmentalists warn that dredging the seafloor will destroy ancient, fragile ecosystems.

The Risk

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We are trading the health of our oceans for the batteries of tomorrow. Once the seabed is destroyed, it will not recover.

DR. ARIS VLAHOS



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